

Vishwa Shanti Janata Party (VSJP)TM
The World's First Fully Digital Transnational Political Party

Founder & International Leader:

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THE CONTINUITY OF DIGNITY — AN ORDINARY HUMAN BEING'S
QUESTION TO THE WORLD

INTERNATIONAL SUBMISSION EDITION — 2026 Version 1.0

Date: 28 September 2026

Place: Keelaperambalur, Perambalur District, Tamil Nadu, India

To

His Excellency,

The Secretary-General,

United Nations,

New York.

Subject: Submission of ***“THE CONTINUITY OF DIGNITY — AN ORDINARY HUMAN BEING'S QUESTION TO THE WORLD”***

Your Excellency,

I respectfully submit for consideration an independent, peaceful and non-binding civil-society ethical–legal and philosophical Appeal entitled:

“THE CONTINUITY OF DIGNITY — AN ORDINARY HUMAN BEING'S QUESTION TO THE WORLD.”

The Appeal arises from a simple universal concern:

WHEN DEPENDENCE INCREASES, DIGNITY MUST NOT DECREASE.

It addresses the practical continuity of dignity where disability, ageing, care, vulnerability or dependence increase the need for assistance. Its principal concerns include:

human dignity and equality;
disability inclusion and practical accessibility;
dignified ageing and continuity of care;
responsible public service;
prevention of avoidable humiliation, exclusion and abandonment;
responsible care for animals placed in sustained human dependence;
the responsibilities of Governments, institutions, communities, families and individuals;
peaceful coexistence;
future generations;
and the ethical principle of continuity with Aram.

The Appeal also asks a wider intergenerational question:

What should the present generation leave to the future?

Not merely whether humanity will continue, but how it will continue. Its ethical direction is:

PEACE SHOULD PROTECT CONTINUITY.

DIGNITY SHOULD GIVE CONTINUITY MEANING.

RESPONSIBILITY SHOULD SUSTAIN CONTINUITY.

COMPASSION SHOULD HUMANISE CONTINUITY.

ARAM SHOULD GUIDE CONSCIENCE.

LAW SHOULD GOVERN LEGAL OBLIGATION.

This document is submitted strictly as an independent civil-society Appeal. It is not a treaty or binding international instrument. It does not represent the United Nations, any State, Government, court, international organisations or public authority. It does not seek compulsory jurisdiction, supranational authority, sanctions, coercive enforcement or unlawful interference. It does not presume or claim endorsement, adoption, recognition, approval, accreditation or deposit by the United Nations or any State or institution. Human rights and animal welfare are treated as legally distinct frameworks.

The Appeal is intended to operate consistently with the Charter of the United Nations, applicable international law, sovereign equality, territorial integrity, political

independence, non-intervention, domestic jurisdiction and State consent where legally required. Its purpose is constructive:

to invite reflection;

to encourage lawful and voluntary improvement;

to strengthen practical dignity and accessibility;

to support continuity of care;

to encourage responsibility where dependence exists;

and to ask what moral example the present generation should leave to the future.

No response, endorsement or action is presumed or demanded. The document is respectfully offered for such consideration as may be appropriate within existing mandates and procedures.

Respectfully submitted,

R NARASIMHAN Digitally signed by R NARASIMHAN
Date: 2026.09.28 09:06:15 +05'30'

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THE CONTINUITY OF DIGNITY — AN ORDINARY HUMAN BEING'S

QUESTION TO THE WORLD

A LIVING GLOBAL ETHICAL–LEGAL AND PHILOSOPHICAL APPEAL

For Human Dignity, Disability Inclusion, Dignified Ageing, Responsible Care, Animal

Welfare, Peace, Future Generations, and Continuity with Aram

INTERNATIONAL SUBMISSION EDITION — 2026

Version 1.0

DOCUMENT CHARACTER

Independent Peaceful Non-Binding Good-Faith Civil-Society Universal in Ethical
Scope Respectful of International Law Non-Coercive Future-Oriented

**FOUNDATIONAL QUESTION WHEN DEPENDENCE INCREASES, WHY
SHOULD DIGNITY DECREASE?**

*FOUNDATIONAL PRINCIPLE WHEN DEPENDENCE INCREASES, DIGNITY
MUST NOT DECREASE.*

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This Appeal presents a universal ethical question arising wherever vulnerability, disability, ageing or dependence increases a person's need for assistance. Its central concern is the distance that can exist between rights recognised in principle and dignity experienced in ordinary life. A public service may formally exist yet remain practically inaccessible. A person may possess legal rights yet still experience humiliation at the point of implementation. An older person may receive care yet lose autonomy, participation or meaningful human connection. An animal placed in

sustained human dependence may receive care while young and later face abandonment when age or illness makes care more difficult.

Future generations may inherit not only institutions and technologies, but also the habits, examples and moral assumptions normalised by the present generation. This Appeal therefore advances several connected principles:

DIGNITY SHOULD NOT DIMINISH WITH DEPENDENCE.

ACCESSIBILITY SHOULD TURN FORMAL EQUALITY INTO LIVED POSSIBILITY.

PUBLIC AUTHORITY SHOULD BE EXERCISED WITH RESPONSIBILITY.

CARE SHOULD CONTINUE THROUGH AGEING, ILLNESS AND DEPENDENCE.

AUTONOMY SHOULD BE PRESERVED WHEREVER REASONABLY AND LAWFULLY POSSIBLE.

HUMAN-CREATED DEPENDENCE SHOULD BE FOLLOWED BY RESPONSIBLE CARE.

PEACE SHOULD PROTECT HUMANE CONTINUITY.

FUTURE GENERATIONS SHOULD INHERIT THE BEST OF OUR CONSCIENCE.

The Appeal distinguishes clearly between human rights and animal welfare. It does not claim identical legal personality or identical legal rights for human beings and non-human animals. Its ethical proposition concerning animals is narrower: where human conduct creates or accepts sustained dependence, responsibility should not disappear merely because care becomes difficult. The document does not seek to impose one model of Government, family, care, public administration or social organisation. Implementation may legitimately differ among States according to their constitutional systems, applicable law, resources, institutions and cultural contexts. The common ethical direction is not institutional uniformity. It is continuity of dignity within lawful diversity. The Appeal is non-binding.

It does not create legal rights or obligations beyond applicable law. It does not alter treaty obligations. It does not claim compulsory jurisdiction, supranational authority, sanctions or coercive enforcement. It respects the Charter of the United Nations, applicable international law, sovereign equality, territorial integrity, political independence, non-intervention, domestic jurisdiction and State consent where legally required.

THE FUTURE-INHERITANCE QUESTION

WHAT SHALL THE PRESENT GENERATION LEAVE TO THE FUTURE?

Peace or violence?

Care or abandonment?

Responsibility or indifference?

Dignity or humiliation?

Continuity guided by conscience,
or repetition of avoidable destruction?

FOUNDATIONAL ETHICAL DIRECTION

PEACE SHOULD PROTECT CONTINUITY.

DIGNITY SHOULD GIVE CONTINUITY MEANING.

RESPONSIBILITY SHOULD SUSTAIN CONTINUITY.

COMPASSION SHOULD HUMANISE CONTINUITY.

ARAM SHOULD GUIDE CONSCIENCE.

LAW SHOULD GOVERN LEGAL OBLIGATION.

CONTINUITY SHOULD SERVE LIFE WITH DIGNITY.

FOUNDATIONAL PHILOSOPHY, DIGNITY, EQUALITY AND ACCESSIBILITY

I. AN ORDINARY HUMAN QUESTION

This Appeal begins with no claim of power. It begins with a question.

When a person becomes more vulnerable, why should that person become less visible?

When assistance becomes more necessary, why should dignity become more difficult to receive? When disability requires accommodation, why should equality depend upon the patience, discretion or exceptional goodwill of another person? The reflection underlying this Appeal arose from an ordinary public-service experience. It is not presented to determine individual fault, to accuse any particular employee, institution or Government, or to treat one observed event as proof of an entire system. It raises a wider question: If a public service formally exists, but a person requiring assistance cannot practically use it with dignity, has formal equality fully become lived equality?

II. THE FOUNDATIONAL PRINCIPLE

The central proposition of this Appeal is:

WHEN DEPENDENCE INCREASES, DIGNITY MUST NOT DECREASE.

Human dignity does not arise from:

physical strength;

independence;

mobility;

sensory ability;

economic productivity;

social influence;

age;

or perceived usefulness.

The need for assistance does not diminish human worth. It may instead increase the responsibility of those who possess the authority, capacity or opportunity to assist.

III. FORMAL EQUALITY AND LIVED EQUALITY

Rights recognised in law are indispensable. But dignity is experienced at the point of implementation:

at a transport terminal;

at a hospital;

at a public office;

at a school;

at a workplace;

at a digital interface;

within a care institution;

and within a home.

A service may formally be open to everyone yet remain practically inaccessible because of:

physical barriers;

communication barriers;

procedural barriers;

digital barriers;

or avoidable attitudinal barriers.

The practical question is therefore not only:

“Does the right exist?”

It is also:

“Can the person actually exercise it with dignity?”

IV. ACCESSIBILITY IS NOT CHARITY

Accessibility is part of meaningful participation. It should not depend, wherever applicable law already requires or policy reasonably permits otherwise, upon exceptional kindness. The governing principles are:

ACCESSIBILITY IS NOT CHARITY.

RESPECT IS NOT CHARITY.

REASONABLE ASSISTANCE IS NOT CHARITY.

HUMAN DIGNITY IS NOT A FAVOUR.

Public systems should seek, within applicable law and available capacity, to make accessibility ordinary rather than exceptional.

V. ACCESSIBILITY IN PRACTICE

Practical accessibility may require attention to:

physical access;

transportation;

information;

communication;

wayfinding;

boarding and alighting;

digital access;

ticketing and procedures;

reasonable assistance;

and accessible grievance mechanisms.

Infrastructure alone is not sufficient. Operational behaviour also matters. A person should, as far as reasonably practicable and consistent with applicable law, be able to:

identify the relevant service;

reach it safely;

understand necessary information;
receive appropriate assistance;
use the service without avoidable humiliation;
and seek review where access is unjustifiably denied.

VI. ASSISTANCE WITHOUT HUMILIATION

Assistance should enable participation. It should not unnecessarily erase autonomy.

Where support is provided, it should seek to preserve:

choice;
privacy;
safety;
personal agency;
and self-respect.

The principle is:

ASSIST WITHOUT HUMILIATING.

GUIDE WITHOUT DOMINATING.

SUPPORT WITHOUT DIMINISHING WORTH.

VII. PUBLIC AUTHORITY AND RESPONSIBILITY

A frontline public employee or service provider may, in a single ordinary interaction, determine whether a recognised right becomes practically usable or inaccessible.

Public-service systems should therefore seek to ensure that:

discretion is exercised lawfully and consistently;
accessibility responsibilities are understood in practice;
persons requiring assistance are treated with patience and respect;
complaints can be raised without intimidation;
and recurring barriers receive appropriate review.

The standard is:

PUBLIC AUTHORITY IS NOT MERELY THE POWER TO DECIDE.

IT IS ALSO THE RESPONSIBILITY TO DECIDE WITH DIGNITY.

VIII. SAFETY AND LAWFUL LIMITATIONS

Accessibility does not require the abandonment of genuine safety requirements. Where operational limitations are necessary, they should be:

lawful;
objective;
proportionate;
non-discriminatory;
and communicated respectfully.

Disability should not become a convenient substitute for proper operational judgment.

The balance is:

SAFETY WITHOUT PRETEXT.

DISCRETION WITHOUT ARBITRARINESS.

ACCESSIBILITY WITHIN LAW.

DIGNITY EVEN WHERE A LIMITATION IS LAWFULLY NECESSARY.

IX. THE PRACTICAL STANDARD

The standard proposed by this Appeal is:

DESIGN FOR ACCESS.

COMMUNICATE FOR INCLUSION.

ASSIST WITHOUT HUMILIATION.

EXERCISE DISCRETION LAWFULLY.

MAKE GRIEVANCE MECHANISMS ACCESSIBLE.

LEARN FROM RECURRING BARRIERS.

AND MAKE DIGNITY REAL AT THE POINT OF IMPLEMENTATION.

DIGNIFIED AGEING, AUTONOMY AND CONTINUITY OF CARE

I. AGEING DOES NOT DIMINISH HUMAN WORTH

Ageing is a stage of life. It is not a reduction in human worth. A person does not become less deserving of dignity because:

strength declines;
mobility changes;
health needs increase;
or assistance becomes necessary.

The governing principle is:

AGE MAY CHANGE CAPACITY.

AGE MUST NOT DIMINISH DIGNITY.

II. DIGNITY THROUGH DEPENDENCE

Dependence may increase with age, illness or disability. That increase should not reduce:

respect;

participation;

personal identity;

or human connection.

The need for assistance should call forth responsibility, not social disappearance.

Accordingly:

DEPENDENCE SHOULD NOT REDUCE RESPECT.

DEPENDENCE SHOULD NOT ERASE DIGNITY.

CARE SHOULD CONTINUE THROUGH CHANGE.

III. AUTONOMY REMAINS CENTRAL

Care should protect the person. It should not unnecessarily replace the person's own voice. Older persons should, wherever reasonably possible and consistent with applicable law, remain involved in decisions concerning:

their daily life;

their place of residence;

their health and care;

their relationships;

and the support they receive.

The standard is:

LISTEN BEFORE DECIDING.

SUPPORT INDEPENDENCE WHERE POSSIBLE.

PROTECT WITHOUT UNNECESSARILY REMOVING AUTONOMY.

IV. NO SINGLE MODEL OF CARE

This Appeal does not prescribe one universal form of ageing or care. Care may lawfully take different forms, including:

care at home;

community-based support;

family-supported care;

assisted living;
residential care;
or institutional support.

Residential or assisted care may, in appropriate circumstances, be:
freely chosen;
necessary;
beneficial;
or lawfully required.

The ethical question is not simply:

“Where does the person live?”

The deeper question is:

“Does dignity follow the person?”

V. DIGNITY SHOULD FOLLOW THE PERSON

Wherever lawful care is provided, the person should remain at the centre of that care.

Care should seek to preserve:

dignity;
autonomy;
safety;
privacy;
participation;
social connection;
and protection from abuse, neglect, coercion or exploitation.

The form of care may change. The continuity of dignity should not.

VI. PREVENTION BEFORE CRISIS

Support should, where possible, begin before:

severe isolation;
caregiver exhaustion;
neglect;
or abandonment.

Governments, communities and institutions may consider, within their lawful roles and available resources:

community-based care;

accessible health and social-care pathways;

care planning;

caregiver support;

respite services;

social connection;

and safeguarding mechanisms.

The principle is:

SUPPORT BEFORE CRISIS.

CONNECT BEFORE ISOLATION.

PLAN BEFORE CARE BREAKS DOWN.

VII. SUPPORT FOR CAREGIVERS

Continuity of care also depends upon those who provide it. Caregivers may carry sustained:

time;

physical effort;

emotional responsibility;

and financial burden.

Where resources permit, appropriate support may include:

information;

training;

respite;

social support;

and access to relevant services.

Protecting continuity of care also requires recognising the needs of those who provide it.

VIII. RESPONSIBLE TRANSITION

There may be circumstances in which a family or individual can no longer provide the required level of care. This reality should not automatically be treated as moral failure.

Where continued personal care becomes genuinely impossible, responsibility should shift toward a lawful and dignified transition. Such transition should, where possible:

protect safety;

respect the wishes and welfare of the person concerned;

preserve meaningful relationships;

and prevent abandonment.

The principle is:

INABILITY TO CONTINUE ONE FORM OF CARE SHOULD NOT BECOME ABANDONMENT OF THE PERSON.

IX. PROTECTION WITHOUT UNNECESSARY CONTROL

Older persons may require safeguards against:

abuse;

coercion;

financial exploitation;

neglect;

and avoidable isolation.

Safeguarding is necessary. But protection should not automatically become unnecessary control. The proper balance is:

PROTECTION WITHOUT HUMILIATION.

AUTONOMY WITHOUT NEGLECT.

CARE WITHOUT DOMINATION.

X. HUMAN CONNECTION

Care should not be reduced to:

food;

medicine;

shelter;

or physical supervision.

Human connection also matters. Being heard matters. Belonging matters. Participation matters. Where reasonably possible, care arrangements should support continued connection with:

family;

friends;

community;

and other meaningful relationships.

A change in residence should not automatically become social disappearance.

XI. ACCESSIBLE GRIEVANCE AND SAFEGUARDING

Older persons receiving care should, where applicable, be able to raise concerns through understandable and accessible mechanisms. Such mechanisms should seek to be:

respectful;

timely;

impartial;

protective of dignity;

and capable of corrective action.

A person should not become voiceless merely because that person depends upon care.

XII. THE PRACTICAL STANDARD

The principles of this section may be summarised as follows:

AGE WITHOUT SOCIAL ERASURE.

CARE WITHOUT ABANDONMENT.

PROTECTION WITHOUT UNNECESSARY CONTROL.

AUTONOMY WHEREVER REASONABLY AND LAWFULLY POSSIBLE.

SUPPORT BEFORE CRISIS.

RESPONSIBLE TRANSITION WHEN CARE MUST CHANGE.

CONTINUITY OF HUMAN CONNECTION.

DIGNITY THROUGHOUT AGEING.

THE FINAL QUESTION IS NOT:

“Must every older person live in one particular form of care?”

IT IS:

“WHATEVER THE LAWFUL FORM OF CARE, WILL DIGNITY CONTINUE?”

The answer offered by this Appeal is:

DIGNITY SHOULD FOLLOW THE PERSON.

RESPONSIBLE ANIMAL CARE, HUMAN-CREATED DEPENDENCE AND SHARED RESPONSIBILITY

I. A DISTINCT BUT CONNECTED ETHICAL QUESTION

A related ethical question arises where non-human animals are:

adopted;

purchased;

rescued;

domesticated;

or otherwise brought into sustained human dependence.

Such animals may rely upon human beings for:

food;

water;

shelter;

safety;

veterinary care;

and protection.

As age, illness or disability increases dependence, responsibility should not disappear merely because care becomes more difficult.

II. HUMAN RIGHTS AND ANIMAL WELFARE REMAIN DISTINCT

This Appeal does not claim:

identical legal personality;

identical legal rights;

or identical legal status for human beings and non-human animals. Human rights and animal welfare remain legally distinct frameworks. The ethical connection advanced here is narrower:

WHERE HUMAN CONDUCT CREATES OR ACCEPTS SUSTAINED DEPENDENCE, RESPONSIBILITY SHOULD ACCOMPANY THAT DEPENDENCE.

III. CARE SHOULD NOT EXPIRE WITH YOUTH

A dependent animal should not lose care merely because it becomes:

older;

less mobile;

ill;

less attractive;

less active;

or more difficult to care for.

The governing principles are:

YOUTH SHOULD NOT BE THE CONDITION FOR CARE.

AGE SHOULD NOT BECOME THE REASON FOR ABANDONMENT.

DEPENDENCE SHOULD NOT BECOME DISPOSABILITY.

IV. RESPONSIBILITY BEFORE DEPENDENCE IS CREATED

Responsible care begins before adoption, acquisition or rescue. Individuals and families should consider, as appropriate:

expected lifespan;

long-term financial capacity;

housing circumstances;

veterinary needs;

ageing-related care;

changes in employment or residence;

contingency arrangements;

and lawful alternatives if direct care later becomes impossible.

A decision made in one moment may create responsibility lasting many years.

V. RESPONSIBLE TRANSITION

There may be genuine circumstances in which continued personal care becomes impossible. The ethical response should not automatically be abandonment. Where reasonably possible and consistent with applicable law, responsibility should seek transition through:

responsible rehoming;

lawful surrender;

transfer to a suitable caregiver;

humane shelter or foster arrangements;

or another safe and lawful form of care.

The principle is:

CARE MAY CHANGE FORM.

RESPONSIBILITY SHOULD NOT SIMPLY DISAPPEAR.

VI. PREVENTION OF AVOIDABLE SUFFERING

Governments, local authorities, veterinary systems, animal-welfare organisations and communities may, within their respective lawful roles, consider:

public education on long-term responsibility;

veterinary and geriatric-animal guidance;

lawful surrender and rehoming mechanisms;

support for humane shelters and foster networks;

prevention of deliberate abandonment and cruelty;

and identification or registration systems where appropriate under domestic law.

The objective is not to impose one universal model of animal care. It is to reduce avoidable suffering where human-created dependence is followed by human withdrawal of care.

VII. SHARED RESPONSIBILITY

The continuity of dignity and responsible care cannot be secured by one actor alone.

Responsibility should be differentiated according to:

lawful authority;

practical capacity;

institutional competence;
and proximity to the person or living being affected.

The governing principle is:

NOT EVERYONE BEARS THE SAME RESPONSIBILITY.

BUT RESPONSIBILITY SHOULD NOT BE EVADED WHERE POWER AND CAPACITY EXIST.

VIII. RESPONSIBILITY OF GOVERNMENTS

Within their constitutional and legal systems, Governments bear responsibility for ensuring that public institutions operate consistently with applicable law. They may, where appropriate:

strengthen accessibility implementation;

support dignified ageing;

maintain accessible grievance mechanisms;

protect against abuse and neglect;

support lawful animal-welfare systems;

and review foreseeable barriers affecting vulnerable or dependent populations.

Government responsibility should not end with legislation. Implementation, supervision, correction and continuous improvement also matter.

IX. RESPONSIBILITY OF INTERNATIONAL INSTITUTIONS

International institutions may contribute strictly within their mandates through:

guidance;

research;

capacity-building;

exchange of good practices;

and technical assistance requested by States.

This Appeal does not ask international institutions to exceed their mandates or replace lawful national authority. International cooperation should remain consistent with applicable international law and State consent where legally required.

X. RESPONSIBILITY OF CIVIL SOCIETY

Civil society may:

identify recurring barriers;
support people using grievance mechanisms;
assist caregivers;
support humane animal-care systems;
conduct research;
and propose practical reforms.

Civil society should act:

accurately;
peacefully;
responsibly;
and without unnecessary sensationalism.

Its purpose should be improvement, not accusation alone.

XI. RESPONSIBILITY OF FAMILIES AND COMMUNITIES

Families should care without unnecessarily erasing autonomy. Communities should support inclusion without stigma. Both may help prevent:

isolation;
abandonment;
avoidable suffering;
and crisis caused by unsupported dependence.

The strongest community is not one in which nobody needs help. It is one in which needing help does not reduce dignity.

XII. RESPONSIBILITY OF INDIVIDUALS

Every individual may encounter moments in which another person or dependent living being requires:

patience;
assistance;
care;
or protection.

Not every such moment creates a legal duty. But many create a moral choice. The individual ethical standard is:

DO NOT HUMILIATE WHEN YOU CAN ASSIST.

DO NOT ABANDON WHEN RESPONSIBILITY CONTINUES.

DO NOT USE POWER TO DIMINISH DIGNITY.

DO NOT LET CONVENIENCE BECOME CRUELTY.

XIII. THE SHARED RESPONSIBILITY FORMULA

RESPONSIBILITY SHOULD FOLLOW POWER.

CARE SHOULD FOLLOW DEPENDENCE.

ACCOUNTABILITY SHOULD FOLLOW PUBLIC DUTY.

COMPASSION SHOULD FOLLOW CAPACITY.

DIGNITY SHOULD ACCOMPANY EVERY HUMAN BEING.

**RESPONSIBLE CARE SHOULD ACCOMPANY HUMAN-CREATED ANIMAL
DEPENDENCE.**

AND CONTINUITY SHOULD PROCEED WITH ARAM.

INTERNATIONAL LEGAL AND POLICY FOUNDATIONS

I. LEGAL-STATUS DISCIPLINE

The ethical propositions advanced in this Appeal are intended to operate consistently with existing international law and United Nations frameworks. The legal character of each source must remain distinct. A treaty obligation is not the same as a declaration. A non-binding General Assembly principle is not the same as a binding treaty provision. A Sustainable Development Goal is not itself a treaty obligation. An ongoing treaty-making process is not the same as an adopted international convention. This Appeal therefore relies upon each source only according to its proper legal character.

II. CHARTER OF THE UNITED NATIONS

The Charter of the United Nations provides the principal international institutional framework within which this Appeal is presented. Its purposes and principles include:

- maintenance of international peace and security;
- peaceful settlement of international disputes;
- international cooperation;
- promotion and encouragement of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms;
- sovereign equality;

good-faith fulfilment of Charter obligations;
and respect for domestic jurisdiction within the Charter framework.

Accordingly, this Appeal is framed consistently with:

PEACEFUL COEXISTENCE WITHOUT COERCION.

INTERNATIONAL COOPERATION WITHOUT UNLAWFUL INTERFERENCE.

RESPONSIBILITY WITHIN LAW.

III. UNIVERSAL DECLARATION OF HUMAN RIGHTS

The Universal Declaration of Human Rights is a foundational international human-rights declaration and a common standard of achievement. It affirms that all human beings are born free and equal in dignity and rights and recognises equality and non-discrimination. This Appeal does not treat the Declaration as though it were itself a treaty. Its relevance here is foundational: human dignity is inherent. It is not earned through:

strength;

independence;

productivity;

age;

physical ability;

or social usefulness.

IV. CONVENTION ON THE RIGHTS OF PERSONS WITH DISABILITIES

The Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities provides the principal international treaty framework specifically concerning the equal enjoyment of human rights by persons with disabilities. For States Parties, obligations arise according to the Convention and applicable international law. The Convention reflects principles including:

inherent dignity;

individual autonomy;

non-discrimination;

participation and inclusion;

equality of opportunity;

and accessibility.

Article 9 requires States Parties to take appropriate measures concerning access, on an equal basis with others, to:

the physical environment;

transportation;

information and communications;

and facilities and services open or provided to the public.

The principle relevant to this Appeal is:

PERSONS WITH DISABILITIES ARE RIGHTS-HOLDERS.

ACCESSIBILITY IS NOT CHARITY.

EQUALITY SHOULD BECOME USABLE IN PRACTICE.

V. ACCESSIBLE TRANSPORT AND THE 2030 AGENDA

The 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development includes Sustainable Development Goal target 11.2. It calls for access to safe, affordable, accessible and sustainable transport systems for all, with particular attention to persons in vulnerable situations, including persons with disabilities and older persons. This is a global development commitment. It is not presented in this Appeal as a substitute for binding treaty obligations or applicable domestic law. Its practical relevance is clear:

TRANSPORT ACCESSIBILITY REQUIRES MORE THAN THE EXISTENCE OF A VEHICLE.

IT ALSO REQUIRES ACTUAL USABILITY.

VI. UNITED NATIONS PRINCIPLES FOR OLDER PERSONS

The United Nations Principles for Older Persons were adopted by the General Assembly in resolution 46/91 of 16 December 1991. They constitute a non-binding international framework organised around:

independence;

participation;

care;

self-fulfilment;

and dignity.

They are not treated here as a binding treaty. Their relevance is ethical and policy-based: ageing should not place a person outside the continuity of dignity, care, participation or social belonging. Accordingly:

AGEING SHOULD NEVER BECOME A REDUCTION IN HUMAN WORTH.

VII. THE EVOLVING INTERNATIONAL FRAMEWORK ON OLDER PERSONS

The international framework concerning the human rights of older persons continues to develop. In 2026, the United Nations Intergovernmental Working Group on Older Persons commenced its first session pursuant to a mandate to elaborate a legally binding international instrument on the human rights of older persons. That process is ongoing. This Appeal does not:

represent that such a convention has already been adopted;

prejudge the negotiations;

or claim any particular eventual outcome.

It respectfully recognises the broader international effort to strengthen the protection and enjoyment of human rights by older persons.

VIII. HUMAN RIGHTS AND ANIMAL WELFARE

Human rights and animal welfare remain legally distinct. Nothing in this Appeal asserts identical:

legal personality;

legal rights;

or legal status between human beings and non-human animals. The ethical proposition concerning animals is based instead upon responsibility arising from human-created or human-accepted dependence. The applicable legal obligations remain governed by the relevant international, regional and domestic legal frameworks.

IX. DIVERSE LEGAL SYSTEMS

This Appeal does not require States to adopt identical:

constitutional arrangements;

legislation;

administrative institutions;

family structures;

care systems;

or policy models.

Implementation may legitimately differ according to:

applicable law;

constitutional systems;

resources;

institutions;

cultural contexts;

and international obligations.

The common direction is not institutional uniformity. It is:

DIGNITY WITHIN LAWFUL DIVERSITY.

X. INTERPRETIVE SAFEGUARD

Nothing in this Appeal should be interpreted as:

creating legal rights or obligations beyond applicable law;

altering treaty obligations;

authoritatively interpreting any treaty;

asserting identical legal status for humans and non-human animals;

creating compulsory jurisdiction;

authorising unlawful intervention;

diminishing sovereign equality;

requiring institutional uniformity;

or replacing existing international, regional or domestic mechanisms.

Each treaty, declaration, resolution, principle and policy framework retains its own legal character, scope and applicable procedures.

XI. THE LEGAL–ETHICAL FORMULA

LAW SHOULD PROTECT DIGNITY.

PUBLIC SYSTEMS SHOULD ENABLE EQUALITY.

ACCESSIBILITY SHOULD BECOME PRACTICAL.

AGE SHOULD NOT DIMINISH HUMAN WORTH.

CARE SHOULD CONTINUE WHEN DEPENDENCE INCREASES.

PEACE SHOULD BE PURSUED CONSISTENTLY WITH LAW.

ARAM SHOULD GUIDE CONSCIENCE.

LAW SHOULD GOVERN LEGAL OBLIGATION.

CONTINUITY SHOULD SERVE LIFE WITH DIGNITY.

GLOBAL IMPLEMENTATION FRAMEWORK FROM PRINCIPLE TO PRACTICE

I. PURPOSE

Dignity becomes meaningful when it can be experienced in ordinary life. Accordingly, the principles of this Appeal should not remain only ethical aspirations. Governments, public authorities, institutions, communities, families and individuals are respectfully invited, within their respective lawful powers, responsibilities and capacities, to consider practical measures through which dignity, accessibility, care and continuity may be strengthened. This framework is voluntary except where duties already arise independently under applicable law.

II. DIGNITY-FIRST PUBLIC SERVICE

Public-facing institutions should seek to deliver services with:

legality;

accessibility;

consistency;

respect;

and regard for human dignity.

Practical measures may include:

disability-awareness and accessibility training;

respectful communication standards;

assistance protocols;

identifiable assistance points;

accessible information;

accessible grievance mechanisms;

and supervisory review of recurring failures.

The objective is:

A PERSON SHOULD NOT HAVE TO DEPEND UPON EXCEPTIONAL KINDNESS IN ORDER TO RECEIVE ORDINARY EQUALITY.

III. ACCESSIBILITY BY DESIGN

Where barriers are foreseeable, accessibility should be considered before exclusion occurs. Public systems should, where reasonably practicable, consider:

- physical access;
- communication access;
- digital accessibility;
- transport access;
- wayfinding;
- accessible information;
- reasonable assistance;
- and usable complaint mechanisms.

The governing principle is:

DESIGN FOR ACCESS BEFORE ACCESS FAILS.

IV. ACCESSIBLE TRANSPORT IN PRACTICE

Public and publicly regulated transport systems should, as far as reasonably practicable and consistent with applicable law, consider measures enabling persons with disabilities and older persons to:

- identify the relevant service;
- reach boarding points safely;
- obtain accessible information;
- board and alight safely;
- receive reasonable assistance without humiliation;
- travel without discriminatory treatment;
- and seek review where access is unjustifiably denied.

Where genuine safety limitations apply, they should be:

- lawful;
- objective;
- proportionate;

non-discriminatory;
and communicated respectfully.

V. CONTINUITY IMPACT ASSESSMENT

This Appeal proposes for voluntary consideration a simple preventive policy tool:

THE CONTINUITY IMPACT ASSESSMENT.

Before introducing or significantly changing a public service, policy, technology or operational practice, competent authorities may consider asking:

Will this create new accessibility barriers?

Will older persons face disproportionate difficulty?

Will persons requiring assistance become unnecessarily dependent upon individual discretion?

Could the measure increase isolation, abandonment or avoidable hardship?

Are accessible alternatives available?

Are grievance mechanisms understandable and usable?

Could foreseeable burdens be transferred to future generations?

The purpose is not to create an automatic veto. It is to make foreseeable vulnerability visible before harm becomes routine.

VI. TRAINING AS PREVENTION

Many failures of dignity arise not from an express rule requiring exclusion, but from weak implementation. Training may therefore include:

disability rights and accessibility;

respectful assistance;

accessible communication;

older-person dignity;

lawful exercise of discretion;

de-escalation;

non-humiliating interaction;

complaint handling;

and prevention of retaliation.

Training should prepare people for real situations, not merely satisfy a procedural requirement.

VII. ACCESSIBLE GRIEVANCE AND FAIR ACCOUNTABILITY

Where access or care fails, a person should be able to raise the concern without further humiliation. Complaint and review mechanisms should, where appropriate, seek to be: understandable;

accessible;

timely;

impartial;

evidence-based;

respectful;

and capable of corrective action.

Accountability should protect the person affected while remaining fair to the person whose conduct is examined. The purpose is:

CORRECTION.

PREVENTION.

INSTITUTIONAL LEARNING.

NOT HUMILIATION.

VIII. SYSTEMIC LEARNING

One incident should not automatically be treated as proof of an entire system. But recurring barriers may require institutional attention. Institutions should therefore be capable of learning from:

complaints;

service denials;

accessibility failures;

communication barriers;

and repeated reports of exclusion.

The relevant questions are:

What occurred?

Why did it occur?

Were applicable standards followed?

What can prevent repetition?

Systemic learning converts experience into improvement.

IX. SUPPORT FOR CARE AND DEPENDENCE

Implementation should also consider the continuity of care. Where appropriate, lawful measures may include:

community-based care;

caregiver support;

respite services;

accessible health and social-care pathways;

protection from abuse or exploitation;

lawful and dignified residential care;

responsible animal-care systems;

humane rehoming or surrender pathways;

and prevention of avoidable abandonment.

The objective is not one universal model of care. It is responsible continuity.

X. TECHNOLOGY AND ACCESSIBILITY

As public services become more digital or automated, technology should be examined for its effect on accessibility. Institutions should consider whether technology:

expands access;

creates new barriers;

removes necessary human assistance;

or excludes persons unable to use standard interfaces.

The principle is:

INNOVATE FOR ACCESS.

DO NOT AUTOMATE EXCLUSION.

XI. PERIODIC REVIEW

Dignity should not be treated as a one-time policy achievement. Institutions may consider periodic review of:

accessibility;

service quality;
complaint patterns;
training effectiveness;
care continuity;
digital access;
and recurring forms of exclusion.

Progress should be measured not only by rules adopted, but also by:
barriers removed;
humiliation prevented;
access improved;
care preserved;
avoidable harm reduced;
and dignity experienced.

XII. IMPLEMENTATION WITHIN LAWFUL DIVERSITY

States and institutions possess different:

legal systems;
resources;
administrative capacities;
and social arrangements.

Implementation may therefore legitimately be:

phased;
proportionate;
context-sensitive;
and adapted to lawful local conditions.

This framework does not seek compulsory uniformity. Its direction is:

DIGNITY WITHIN DIVERSITY.

RESPONSIBILITY WITHIN LAWFUL AUTHORITY.

IMPLEMENTATION WITHOUT COERCION.

XIII. IMPLEMENTATION FORMULA DESIGN FOR ACCESS.

TRAIN FOR DIGNITY.

COMMUNICATE FOR INCLUSION.

CARE THROUGH DEPENDENCE.

SUPPORT CAREGIVERS.

PREVENT AVOIDABLE ABANDONMENT.

MAKE GRIEVANCE SYSTEMS ACCESSIBLE.

ENSURE FAIR ACCOUNTABILITY.

LEARN FROM RECURRING FAILURE.

USE TECHNOLOGY TO EXPAND ACCESS.

REVIEW PROGRESS CONTINUOUSLY.

IMPLEMENT WITHIN LAW.

CONTINUE WITH ARAM.

FUTURE GENERATIONS, PEACE AND THE ETHICS OF CONTINUITY

I. THE QUESTION OF INHERITANCE

Every generation inherits more than infrastructure. It inherits:

institutions;

technologies;

social practices;

habits;

examples;

and the moral architecture of everyday life.

Future generations learn not only from what the present generation says, but from what it repeatedly makes normal. They observe:

how disability is treated;

how ageing is treated;

how dependence is treated;

how authority is exercised;

how animals under human care are treated;

and how disagreement and conflict are managed.

The question is therefore not only:

“What will we leave behind?”

It is also:

“WHAT WILL WE TEACH THE FUTURE TO CONTINUE?”

II. CONTINUITY ALONE IS NOT ENOUGH

Continuity is necessary. But continuity alone is not sufficient. Violence can continue. Hatred can continue. Exclusion can continue. Humiliation can continue. Abandonment can continue. The fact that something has continued does not prove that it deserves to continue. The ethical question is therefore:

WHAT SHOULD CONTINUE?

AND

WHAT SHOULD END BEFORE IT BECOMES THE INHERITANCE OF THE FUTURE?

III. THE CHARACTER OF CONTINUITY

This Appeal therefore distinguishes between mere continuation and humane continuity. Humane continuity should be shaped by:

dignity;

equality;

responsibility;

care;

compassion;

restraint;

peaceful coexistence;

and protection against avoidable harm.

The governing proposition is:

**CONTINUITY SHOULD PRESERVE WHAT MAKES LIFE MORE DIGNIFIED,
RESPONSIBLE AND HUMANE.**

IV. PEACE AS A PROTECTOR OF CONTINUITY

Violence can destroy in moments what generations required years to build. It can damage:

human life;

families;

communities;

homes;
health systems;
education;
livelihoods;
social trust;
and the conditions required for future life.

Accordingly:

PEACE SHOULD PROTECT CONTINUITY.

This is an ethical proposition. It does not alter the Charter of the United Nations or applicable international law. It asks only that avoidable destruction not be treated as inevitable where peaceful and lawful means remain available.

V. DIFFERENCE WITHOUT DEHUMANISATION

Peace does not require humanity to become identical. States, societies and individuals will continue to differ in:

culture;
law;
belief;
history;
identity;
political systems;
and national interests.

The task is not to eliminate difference. It is to prevent difference from becoming a justification for dehumanisation. Accordingly:

DIFFERENCE SHOULD NOT BECOME HATRED.

DISAGREEMENT SHOULD NOT BECOME DEHUMANISATION.

POWER SHOULD NOT BECOME DOMINATION.

PEACEFUL COEXISTENCE IS NOT SAMENESS.

IT IS THE RESPONSIBLE COEXISTENCE OF DIFFERENCE.

VI. PEACE WITHIN LAW

This Appeal does not independently determine the legality of any particular conflict or use of force. It does not prejudge disputes between States. Its general direction is:

disputes should be addressed consistently with the Charter of the United Nations and applicable international law;

peaceful means should be pursued where available;

and dignity should not disappear merely because disagreement exists.

The governing formula is:

ARAM SHOULD GUIDE CONSCIENCE.

LAW SHOULD GOVERN LEGAL OBLIGATION.

PEACE SHOULD BE PURSUED WITHIN LAW.

VII. FUTURE GENERATIONS AND MORAL EXAMPLE

Children and young people learn from repeated social behaviour. If they repeatedly observe:

exclusion;

abandonment;

humiliation;

violence;

or indifference, those patterns may become normal. If they observe:

dignity;

patience;

responsibility;

care;

restraint;

dialogue;

and peaceful coexistence, a different future becomes possible. The future inherits the moral habits of the present.

VIII. RESPONSIBILITY TO THOSE YET TO COME

Future generations cannot directly participate in many decisions made today. They cannot object to present neglect. They cannot repair present destruction before inheriting its consequences. This Appeal does not, by this proposition alone, create new legal personality or enforceable rights beyond applicable law. It advances an ethical principle:

THE INABILITY OF FUTURE PERSONS TO SPEAK IN THE PRESENT SHOULD NOT MAKE THE FORESEEABLE FUTURE INVISIBLE.

IX. THE FUTURE-INHERITANCE PRINCIPLE

The present generation should therefore ask:

Will we leave peace or repeated violence?

Care or abandonment?

Responsibility or indifference?

Dignity or humiliation?

Restraint or domination?

Continuity guided by conscience, or repetition of avoidable harm?

The answer offered by this Appeal is:

PEACE SHOULD PROTECT CONTINUITY.

DIGNITY SHOULD GIVE CONTINUITY MEANING.

RESPONSIBILITY SHOULD SUSTAIN CONTINUITY.

COMPASSION SHOULD HUMANISE CONTINUITY.

FUTURE GENERATIONS SHOULD INHERIT THE BEST OF OUR CONSCIENCE.

AND CONTINUITY SHOULD PROCEED WITH ARAM.

GLOBAL APPEAL AND VOLUNTARY COMMITMENTS FOR THE FUTURE FROM CONSCIENCE TO CONTINUITY

I. CHARACTER OF THE COMMITMENTS

This Appeal respectfully invites Governments, public authorities, international institutions, civil society, communities, families and individuals to consider the following voluntary commitments. They do not create legal obligations beyond applicable law. They do not require institutional uniformity. They do not diminish sovereignty, domestic jurisdiction, constitutional diversity or lawful national discretion. They are offered as ethical–legal directions capable of adaptation within different lawful systems.

II. VOLUNTARY COMMITMENT 1

MAKE DIGNITY PRACTICAL

Do not ask only:

“Does the right exist?”

Also ask:

“Can the person actually exercise it with dignity?”

Progress should be measured not only by rules adopted, but also by dignity experienced.

III. VOLUNTARY COMMITMENT 2

DESIGN PUBLIC SERVICES FOR INCLUSION

Where reasonably practicable:

anticipate accessibility;

organise assistance;

make communication understandable;

and reduce unnecessary dependence upon individual goodwill.

Respect should be standard. Avoidable exclusion should not be normal.

IV. VOLUNTARY COMMITMENT 3

TRAIN AUTHORITY TO SERVE WITH DIGNITY

Frontline personnel should, where appropriate, receive training concerning:

disability inclusion;

accessible communication;

respectful assistance;

older-person dignity;

lawful discretion;

non-humiliating interaction;

and grievance handling.

Authority should never become permission to diminish dignity.

V. VOLUNTARY COMMITMENT 4

PROTECT DIGNITY THROUGHOUT AGEING

Strengthen lawful systems that support:

autonomy;

participation;

social connection;

care access;
protection from abuse or exploitation;
caregiver support;
and dignified residential or community-based care where appropriate.

Ageing is a stage of life. It is not a reduction in human worth.

VI. VOLUNTARY COMMITMENT 5

RECOGNISE THE CONTINUITY OF CARE

Where a person or animal becomes substantially dependent upon an established relationship of care, responsibility should not disappear merely because care becomes difficult. Where direct care genuinely becomes impossible, responsible, lawful and humane transition should be pursued.

CARE MAY CHANGE FORM.

RESPONSIBILITY SHOULD NOT SIMPLY DISAPPEAR.

VII. VOLUNTARY COMMITMENT 6

CONSIDER FORESEEABLE IMPACT BEFORE HARM OCCURS

Before major changes in public services, policies, technologies or operational practices, consider whether they may create foreseeable barriers or hardship for:

persons with disabilities;

older persons;

persons requiring assistance;

caregivers;

and, where relevant, dependent animals. Prevention is often more humane than correction after harm occurs.

VIII. VOLUNTARY COMMITMENT 7

CREATE ACCESSIBLE AND TRUSTED GRIEVANCE SYSTEMS

Complaint and review mechanisms should, where appropriate, seek to be:

understandable;

accessible;

timely;

impartial;

evidence-based;
respectful;
and capable of corrective action.

People should not fear humiliation merely because they ask an institution to examine a failure.

IX. VOLUNTARY COMMITMENT 8

SUPPORT CAREGIVERS

Continuity of care depends upon those who provide it. Where resources permit, appropriate support may include:

information;
training;
respite;
mental-health and social support;
and access to relevant services.

Protecting care also requires supporting the caregiver.

X. VOLUNTARY COMMITMENT 9

TEACH RESPONSIBLE CONTINUITY TO FUTURE GENERATIONS

Education should not teach achievement alone. It should also help cultivate:

dignity;
non-discrimination;
accessibility;
respect for ageing;
responsible care;
compassion;
peaceful communication;
and responsibility for consequences.

THE FUTURE INHERITS THE MORAL HABITS OF THE PRESENT.

XI. VOLUNTARY COMMITMENT 10

REVIEW PROGRESS CONTINUOUSLY

Governments and institutions may consider periodic review of:

accessibility;
service quality;
complaint patterns;
older-person protection;
care continuity;
training effectiveness;
and recurring forms of exclusion.
Progress should be measured by:
barriers removed;
humiliation prevented;
access improved;
care preserved;
and dignity experienced.

XII. A GLOBAL ETHICAL COMMITMENT

This Appeal respectfully proposes:

WE WILL NOT TREAT DEPENDENCE AS INFERIORITY.

WE WILL NOT TREAT DISABILITY AS INVISIBILITY.

WE WILL NOT TREAT AGE AS DISPOSABILITY.

WE WILL NOT TREAT CARE AS TEMPORARY WHEN DEPENDENCE CONTINUES.

WE WILL NOT TREAT ANIMALS UNDER HUMAN CARE AS OBJECTS OF CONVENIENCE.

WE WILL NOT ALLOW AUTHORITY TO BECOME HUMILIATION.

WE WILL NOT TREAT DIFFERENCE AS A REASON FOR DEHUMANISATION.

WE WILL SEEK TO MAKE DIGNITY PRACTICAL.

WE WILL SEEK TO MAKE ACCESSIBILITY ORDINARY.

WE WILL SEEK TO MAKE RESPONSIBILITY ENDURE.

WE WILL SEEK TO PRESERVE PEACEFUL COEXISTENCE.

WE WILL SEEK TO LEAVE FUTURE GENERATIONS A WORLD WORTH CONTINUING.

WE WILL SEEK CONTINUITY WITH ARAM.

XIII. THE CALL

Let Governments govern with dignity. Let institutions implement with humanity. Let civil society advocate with accuracy and peace. Let families care without erasing autonomy. Let communities include without stigma. Let individuals assist without humiliating. Let technology expand access rather than exclusion. Let peace protect humane continuity. Let future generations inherit not merely a more advanced world, but a more humane one.

DIGNITY MUST CONTINUE.

EQUALITY MUST CONTINUE.

CARE MUST CONTINUE.

RESPONSIBILITY MUST CONTINUE.

COMPASSION MUST CONTINUE.

PEACE SHOULD PROTECT CONTINUITY.

ARAM MUST CONTINUE.

THE DEEPER QUESTION IS NOT ONLY:

WILL LIFE CONTINUE?

IT IS:

HOW WILL LIFE CONTINUE?

The answer offered by this Appeal is:

WITH DIGNITY.

WITH RESPONSIBILITY.

WITH COMPASSION.

WITH PEACE.

WITH LAW GOVERNING LEGAL OBLIGATION.

WITH ARAM GUIDING CONSCIENCE.

FINAL DECLARATION, LIVING-DOCUMENT SAFEGUARD,
PHILOSOPHICAL CODA AND AUTHENTICATION

I. FINAL DECLARATION

This Appeal places before the world one enduring proposition:

WHEN DEPENDENCE INCREASES, DIGNITY MUST NOT DECREASE.

Accordingly:

NO HUMAN BEING SHOULD LOSE DIGNITY BECAUSE OF DISABILITY.

NO HUMAN BEING SHOULD LOSE WORTH BECAUSE OF AGE.

NO PERSON SHOULD BE HUMILIATED FOR REQUIRING ASSISTANCE.

NO PUBLIC SERVICE SHOULD NORMALISE AVOIDABLE EXCLUSION.

NO RELATIONSHIP OF CARE SHOULD TREAT DEPENDENCE AS DISPOSABILITY.

NO ANIMAL DEPENDENT UPON HUMAN CARE SHOULD BE SUBJECTED TO AVOIDABLE ABANDONMENT, CRUELTY OR SUFFERING.

NO GENERATION SHOULD INHERIT THE IDEA THAT ONLY THE STRONG, INDEPENDENT OR CONVENIENT DESERVE CARE.

The question before humanity is therefore not merely:

WILL WE CONTINUE?

It is:

HOW WILL WE CONTINUE?

The answer offered by this Appeal is:

WITH DIGNITY.

WITH EQUALITY.

WITH RESPONSIBILITY.

WITH CARE.

WITH COMPASSION.

WITH PEACE.

WITH RESPECT FOR DIFFERENCE.

WITH RESPONSIBILITY TOWARD FUTURE GENERATIONS.

WITH LAW GOVERNING LEGAL OBLIGATION.

WITH ARAM GUIDING CONSCIENCE.

II. LIVING-DOCUMENT SAFEGUARD

This Appeal is intended to remain a living civil-society document. Future editions may be transparently reviewed or refined as international law, knowledge, technology, demographics, accessibility and systems of care evolve. Each substantive revision should be dated and versioned. No future revision should weaken the foundational safeguards of this Appeal, including:

human dignity;

equality and non-discrimination;

autonomy;

accessibility;
peaceful conduct;
responsibility toward dependence;
protection from avoidable suffering;
the legal distinction between human rights and animal welfare;
sovereign equality;
non-intervention;
State consent where legally required;
and the principle that law governs legal obligation.

Its language may evolve. Its implementation may improve. Its foundational conscience should remain:

WHEN DEPENDENCE INCREASES, DIGNITY MUST NOT DECREASE.

III. PHILOSOPHICAL CODA

CONTINUITY WITH ARAM

Life may change. Bodies may weaken. Needs may increase. Circumstances may transform. But dignity must continue. Care must continue. Responsibility must continue. Compassion must continue. Peace should protect continuity.

And Aram must continue.

Continuity is not merely survival. It is the preservation of dignity through change. It is responsibility that remains when dependence begins. It is compassion that survives inconvenience. It is power restrained by conscience. It is progress guided by humanity. Because the true future of humanity is not measured only by how far we advance. It is also measured by what—and whom—we refuse to leave behind.

IV. FINAL ETHICAL FORMULATION

ARAM SHOULD GUIDE CONSCIENCE.

LAW SHOULD GOVERN LEGAL OBLIGATION.

DIGNITY SHOULD ACCOMPANY EVERY HUMAN LIFE.

RESPONSIBILITY SHOULD ACCOMPANY POWER.

CARE SHOULD ENDURE THROUGH DEPENDENCE.

COMPASSION SHOULD SURVIVE INCONVENIENCE.

PEACE SHOULD PROTECT CONTINUITY.

CONTINUITY SHOULD SERVE LIFE WITH DIGNITY.

FROM ARMS TO ARAM.

V. AUTHENTICATION AND AUTHOR'S DECLARATION

I affirm that this document is presented independently and in good faith as a peaceful, non-binding civil-society ethical–legal and philosophical Appeal. It does not constitute a treaty, binding international instrument, judicial determination, governmental representation or instrument of the United Nations. It does not claim endorsement, adoption, recognition, accreditation, approval or official status by the United Nations, any State, Government or institution. It creates no legal rights or obligations beyond applicable law. It seeks no compulsory jurisdiction, supranational authority, sanctions, coercive enforcement or unlawful interference. Nothing in this document shall be interpreted as advocating coercion, discrimination, hostility, violence, unlawful intervention or violation of applicable international or domestic law.

Human rights and animal welfare remain legally distinct. “Aram” is advanced as an ethical guide to conscience, not as a source of binding legal obligation.

Respectfully submitted,

R NARASIMHAN  Digitally signed by R NARASIMHAN
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VI. SELECTED INTERNATIONAL LEGAL AND POLICY FOUNDATIONS

1. Charter of the United Nations. 2. Universal Declaration of Human Rights, General Assembly resolution 217 A (III), 10 December 1948. 3. Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, General Assembly resolution 61/106, 13 December 2006. 4. United Nations Principles for Older Persons, General Assembly resolution 46/91, 16 December 1991. 5. Transforming our world: the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable

Development, General Assembly resolution 70/1, including Sustainable Development Goal target 11.2. Relevant international, regional, national and local standards retain their respective legal character, scope and applicable procedures.

DOCUMENT STATUS

Independent | Peaceful | Non-Binding | Good-Faith Civil-Society Appeal | Non-Coercive | Future-Oriented | Respectful of International Law and Sovereign Equality